

# Style Guide and Naming Conventions

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## 1. INTRODUCTION

### 1.1. The case for a Vox Mobile style guide

To enhance the effectiveness of Vox Mobile's customer relations and communications, it is important that all business documentation be consistent with its corporate image. Corporate identity promotes cohesiveness and establishes a sense of stability and reliability. This, in turn, instills confidence in existing and potential customers. Similar to the way a company establishes its branding guidelines, it also must develop its own style and usage guidelines for business content.

A style guide is a reference document that contains a set of instructions defining the business guidelines for designing, developing, editing, and presenting company information. The purpose of a style guide is to:

- Enable consistency within documents and allow a consistent presentation of information across the company.
- Create a familiar tone for all external publications so that published documents conform to the business image and policy, including legal requirements.
- Provide a common vocabulary.
- Provide an orientation or training aid for new employees or new team members.
- Define which style issues are negotiable and which are not.
- Remove the repetition of the decision-making process and reproduction of common elements.

### 1.2. Developing the appropriate style guide

An effective way to create an appropriate style for content, and ensure all employees follow the style requirements, is to produce an in-house style guide backed by an industry-standard style guide (as a point of reference for discrepancies).

The following industry-standard style resources are recommended because of the type of industry Vox Mobile operates within and the type of documents it produces. These style resources are listed in the order of relevance. **This document, and the recommended style guides, will function as Vox Mobile's corporate style and usage guide for business content.**

| STYLE GUIDE                                                                 | URL                                                                                                                          | USED FOR                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>The Chicago Manual of Style, 16<sup>th</sup> Edition</i>                 | <a href="http://www.chicagomanualofstyle.org">www.chicagomanualofstyle.org</a>                                               | The authoritative, trusted source that writers, editors, and publishers turn to for guidance on style and process.           |
| <i>Microsoft Manual of Style for Technical Publications, Fourth Edition</i> | <a href="http://www.microsoft.com/learning/en/us/Book.aspx?ID=15053">www.microsoft.com/learning/en/us/Book.aspx?ID=15053</a> | An essential reference for technical writers, editors, journalists, and content workers who write about computer technology. |

## 2. VOX MOBILE STYLE AND USAGE GUIDE FOR CONTENT

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This section is intended to address recurring questions related to writing style and word usage in Vox Mobile documentation. This guide is not intended to replace the **Vox Mobile Branding Guidelines** or the **Vox Mobile Brand Book**, but to work in unison with these established corporate standards to create an effective strategy for communicating and connecting with the reader.

### 2.1. Tone

The tone of a message is important whether writing a memo, letter, report, or any type of business document. This tone is a reflection of the writing source, and it will affect how the reader perceives the message and the company.

Vox Mobile exemplifies its tonal values through its Vox Voice:

- CONFIDENT with knowledge and experience
- HUMBLE with understanding
- PASSIONATE with dynamism and energy
- STRAIGHTFORWARD with honesty and clarity

For a more complete discussion on the tone and voice of Vox Mobile collateral, refer to the **Vox Mobile Brand Guidelines** and the **Vox Mobile Brand Book**.

#### 2.1.1. Customer stories

In customer case studies, success stories, and testimonials, strive for an objective, neutral tone. Although this type of content often includes market-oriented language, it should read as if it were written by an independent third party.

#### 2.1.2. Technical material

For technical material such as blueprints and white papers, keep the tone factual and avoid marketing language. Readers of technical pieces are looking to Vox Mobile for technical insight, expertise, and education, not a sales pitch.

### 2.2. General style notes

In general, follow the basic rules of grammar and use the following style notes for Vox Mobile-specific content. For discrepancies that are not identified within these style notes, refer to *The Chicago Manual of Style* as the primary source and then *Microsoft's Manual of Style for Technical Publications* as the secondary source.

**Abbreviations**      Abbreviations for places (such as "U.S." or "U.K.") should maintain the periods for clarity.

**Acronyms**            Spell out term on first reference followed by the acronym in parentheses. Use the acronym only in subsequent references.

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Acronyms are usually written in all-caps and without periods (of course, there are a few exceptions).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Ampersand (&amp;)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Do not use an ampersand (&) as a substitute for the word “and.” Use it only for proper names like in Johnson & Johnson or Procter & Gamble.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Apostrophes</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Do not use an apostrophe in the plural form of an acronym or abbreviation (e.g., use PCs not PC’s).<br><br>When using decades, do you use an apostrophe before the “s” (e.g., Use 1990s not 1990’s).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Bullet points</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Capitalize the first letter after all bulleted and numbered lists. Punctuate the bulleted text according to standard punctuation rules: A complete sentence requires a period, whereas a phrase does not.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Bullet points, structure</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Use parallel, grammatical structure for bulleted lists: If most of the bullets in a series are verb phrases, try to make them all verb phrases. If most are complete sentences that begin with a verb, try to make them all complete sentences that begin with a verb.<br><br><table> <tr> <td><b>Correct:</b></td><td><b>Incorrect:</b></td></tr> <tr> <td> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Ensure that the sales associate understands the customer’s requirement.</li> <li>■ Facilitate the group’s overall understanding of the workshop and end products.</li> <li>■ Keep the customer engagement process upbeat and positive.</li> </ul> </td><td> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Understanding the need to change our approach (verb phrase, fragment)</li> <li>■ Flexibility to adapt to the client’s business objectives (noun phrase, fragment)</li> <li>■ Vox Mobile offers tools and solutions that help customers make informed decisions. (complete sentence)</li> </ul> </td></tr> </table> | <b>Correct:</b> | <b>Incorrect:</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Ensure that the sales associate understands the customer’s requirement.</li> <li>■ Facilitate the group’s overall understanding of the workshop and end products.</li> <li>■ Keep the customer engagement process upbeat and positive.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Understanding the need to change our approach (verb phrase, fragment)</li> <li>■ Flexibility to adapt to the client’s business objectives (noun phrase, fragment)</li> <li>■ Vox Mobile offers tools and solutions that help customers make informed decisions. (complete sentence)</li> </ul> |
| <b>Correct:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>Incorrect:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
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| <b>Capitalization</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <p><b>Titles:</b> Generally, the first word in a title should always use an initial capital letter and the rest of the title should be lowercase. However, when elements require extra emphasis or function as a proper noun, those words in the title can be initial-capped.</p> <p><b>Heading and subheads:</b> The first word in a heading or subhead should always use an initial capital letter. Capitalize the first word and any proper nouns, titles, or acronyms only. If a heading or subhead is a complete sentence, it should end with appropriate punctuation.</p> <p><b>Body text:</b> Capitalize the first word of every sentence, whether or not it is a complete sentence.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Captions and callouts</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Use sentence case structure. Punctuate the text according to standard punctuation rules.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                 |                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

## Collective nouns

Treat company and department names as collective nouns that take singular verbs and singular pronouns.

### Correct:

- Company WYSI **has its** own way of managing its mobile devices.
- The IT department **has its** own way of approaching cloud computing.

### Incorrect:

- Company WYSI **have their** own way of managing its mobile devices.
- The IT department **have their** own way of approaching cloud computing.

## Colons

In **titles, headings, and subheads**, do not capitalize the first letter following a colon, regardless of what follows (e.g. Mobility enterprise: management of large-scale mobile device deployments).

In **body text**, capitalize the first word following a colon if what follows is a complete sentence. Otherwise, use lowercase (e.g., Vox Procure: Stay in control of your Mobile Connected workforce.).

## Commas

Use a serial comma (i.e., a comma before the “and” or “or” in a simple series of three or more items).

## Common nouns vs. proper nouns

Avoid turning common nouns into proper nouns. Terms such as mobile device management, operating system, and service level agreement are common nouns that describe types of things. When these terms are used descriptively, as opposed to uses in Vox Mobile-branded service or solution names, they are best attributed in lowercase. This is the case even though the same terms are often expressed as upper case abbreviations or acronyms such as *MDM*, *OS*, and *SLA*.

## Dashes

A **hyphen** is used to separate two words, as in “high-quality” phone.

An **en dash** is used between dates or number ranges and includes spaces on either side of the dash, as in “1990 – 1995 or 26.5 – 28.1.”

An **em dash** is used for a break in thought and does not include spaces around the dash, as in “The first thought is explained here—then the second thought.”

## Numbers

In **body text**, spell out numbers one through ten; use figures for numbers 11 and above. In **charts, graphs, and tables**, figures are acceptable for all numbers. Use words for numbers at the **beginning of a sentence**.

## Prefixes

For clarity and readability, hyphenate words that begin with common prefixes such as: non-, multi-, pre-, and co- (e.g., pre-approval, co-author, multi-tasking, non-profit).

## Proper names and nouns

Always capitalize the first letter of proper names, proper nouns, names

## Slashes

of countries and cities, and calendar headings.

Do not add spaces before or after a slash when separating words.

## Web addresses

When including URLs in body text, try to use short URLs that will be easy for readers to key in. In marketing pieces, bold the URL name (e.g., Use **www.voxmobile.com** instead of <http://www.voxmobile.com>).

**Consistency is the ultimate goal.** If you can't determine a style rule after consulting this guide or other Vox Mobile-approved style resources, follow your best judgment or ask the content provider to select a preferred style. In every instance, the goal is consistency within the document you are creating.

## 2.3. Commonly used words

Taking a consistent approach to commonly used words makes life simple for everyone involved in content creation. It reduces the number of decisions writers and editors need to make. Additionally, the customer will appreciate a more predictable experience with Vox Mobile's content.

|                            |                               |                      |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------|
| backup (noun, adj.)        | HTML                          | third-party (adj.)   |
| back up (verb)             | industry-standard             | timeline             |
| business-to-business (B2B) | Internet                      | United States (noun) |
| e-business                 | intranet                      | U.S. (adj.)          |
| e-commerce                 | lifecycle <sup>1</sup>        | user-centered (adj.) |
| e-mail                     | login (noun, adj.)            | voicemail            |
| end user (noun)            | log in (verb)                 | web                  |
| end-user (adj.)            | logon (noun, adj.)            | web-based            |
| every day (noun)           | log on (verb)                 | web page             |
| everyday (adj.)            | offline                       | website              |
| help desk (noun)           | on-demand (adj.)              | Wi-Fi                |
| help-desk (adj.)           | online                        | workflow             |
| high tech (noun)           | real time (noun)              | workstation          |
| high-tech (adj.)           | real-time (adj.)              |                      |
| homepage                   | service level agreement (SLA) |                      |

<sup>1</sup> Some dictionaries still show this term as two words (life cycle) in the noun and adjective form. Vox Mobile's use of this term follows an emerging convention in the IT industry.



## 2.4. Copyrights and disclaimers

The following information should be included at the end of Vox Mobile documentation.

© Copyright 2013 Vox Mobile. The information contained herein is subject to change without notice. Vox Mobile shall not be liable for technical or editorial errors or omissions contained herein.

Additional information about copyright date:

- The copyright date should be the year the work was originally published.
- The date must not be more recent than the actual year of first publication. Forfeiture of the copyright can result from using too recent a date; if there is doubt, it is better to err by using a date that is too early rather than one that is too recent.
- If a work has been revised, the copyright notice should also include either (i) all the years in which the work was revised or (ii) the year of the most recent revision, for example:
  - © Copyright 2004 – 2013 Vox Mobile
  - © Copyright 2004 – 2009, 2009 – 2012, 2013 Vox Mobile
  - © Copyright 2004, 2013 Vox Mobile
- Including all revision years may be appropriate when you want to make it clear that the work has been regularly revised. The shorter form may be more appropriate when space for the notice is limited (for example, on a CD).

## 2.5. Glossary of Vox Mobile terminology

**Bring Your Own Device (BYOD):** Individually owned mobile device that utilizes individually liable wireless plans connected to a company's network.

**Corporate Liable (CL):** Devices and mobile numbers that are tied to and associated with a company.

**Device wiping:** Erasing some or all corporate data and applications from a mobile device.

**Enterprise mobility:** The shifting trend in work habits that relies more heavily on mobile devices and cloud services to perform business tasks.

**Enterprise Mobility Management (EMM):** A set of people, processes, and technology dedicated to managing mobile devices, wireless networks, and related services to facilitate using a wide array of mobile computing for business.

**Individual Liable (IL):** Devices and mobile numbers that are tied to and associated with the individual user. The user owns the mobile number and equipment and is financially responsible for the monthly carrier services.

**Jailbreaking:** A device hack that provides users with unrestricted access to the entire file system on their mobile devices.

**Jailbreak device:** A device that allows you to run third-party programs and other code.



**Root device:** Jailbreaking on an Android-specific device.

**Mobile application:** Software designed for any or all the mobile devices defined in this policy.

**Mobile device:** Any hand-held, cellular or wireless mobile communications device and related software that captures or transfers information for transmission over a wireless services provider's network or Wi-Fi hotspot. This includes, but is not limited to, cellular phones, smartphones, personal digital assistants (PDAs), two-way radios, satellite phones, tablets, and pagers. Mobile devices include all said equipment regardless if it is corporately or individually owned or supplied.

**Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Software and services that are established to manage and control access to mobile applications used in business on company-provided devices and BYOD.

**Mobile Device Management (MDM):** A combination of software and mobile applications that allow users to connect a mobile device to the company's network while securing company information.

**Personal digital assistant (PDA):** An electronic handheld information and personal organizing device.

**Tethering:** Using your cell phone, or other Internet-enabled mobile devices, as a modem for another device such as a PDA or notebook.

**Vox Architect:** Through customer engagements, identify enterprise mobility challenges and architect managed mobility solutions.

**Vox Deploy:** Provides a multi-device, multi-platform deployment capability by assisting customers with device configuration and deploying them to end users or locations.

**Vox Procure:** Self-serve portal customized to corporate standards containing an approved catalog of devices based on end user needs.

**Wi-Fi:** A type of wireless networking protocol (usually a wireless local area network based on the 802.11 IEEE network standards) that allows devices to communicate without cords or cables.

## 3. NAMING CONVENTIONS FOR VOX MOBILE FOLDERS AND FOLDERS

The naming conventions included in this section apply to electronic documents and folders created in a desktop environment and stored in a shared directory. These guidelines should be part of Vox Mobile's defined business practices for managing shared electronic workspaces.

The structure of directories, folders, and files is essentially the same whether you are working on a standalone PC, a standalone server, a linked server, or a control repository. There are, however, subtle differences between workspaces that may dictate the way directories, folders, and files are named.

### 3.1. Folder structure

Directory and folder structures should contain information that defines the file content. When there are multiple levels of folders, the naming convention of each folder should be considered based on the following aspects:

- **Location** – The folder structure is only useful as long as the document resides in the same folder. Once the file is moved or reclassified, it should be renamed.
- **Length restrictions** – Standard desktop applications have a limit of 255 characters for the entire path and filename. If the name is longer than 255 characters, the system will truncate it and it could pose file access errors.
- **Web documents** – Internet file naming conventions might require a different approach depending on the application used. Typically, Internet file names are shorter and rely on metatags and metadata to support search engine queries.

In many cases, the folder structure can carry some of the burden of the file name (See Table 1). This helps minimize complexity with the file naming because the folder already contains much of the information needed for the user to locate and access the appropriate documents.

**Table 1: An effective folder structure takes some of the burden off of the file name.**

| Folder Requirement                      | Folder Structure                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vox Consulting Services – MODULES       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Modules\Policy</li><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Modules\MDM</li><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Modules\MCoE</li><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Modules\Tablet</li></ul>                         |
| Vox Consulting Services – PRESENTATIONS | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Presentations\Policy</li><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Presentations\MDM</li><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Presentations\MCoE</li><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Presentations\Tablet</li></ul> |
| Vox Consulting Services – POLICIES      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Policies\DSW</li><li>▪ VoxArchitect\Policies\Tembec</li></ul>                                                                                                 |

**Table 1: An effective folder structure takes some of the burden off of the file name.**

| Folder Requirement                       | Folder Structure                                                              |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ VoxArchitect\Policies\TCI</li> </ul> |
| <b>Vox Consulting Services – SURVEYS</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ VoxArchitect\Surveys\...</li> </ul>  |

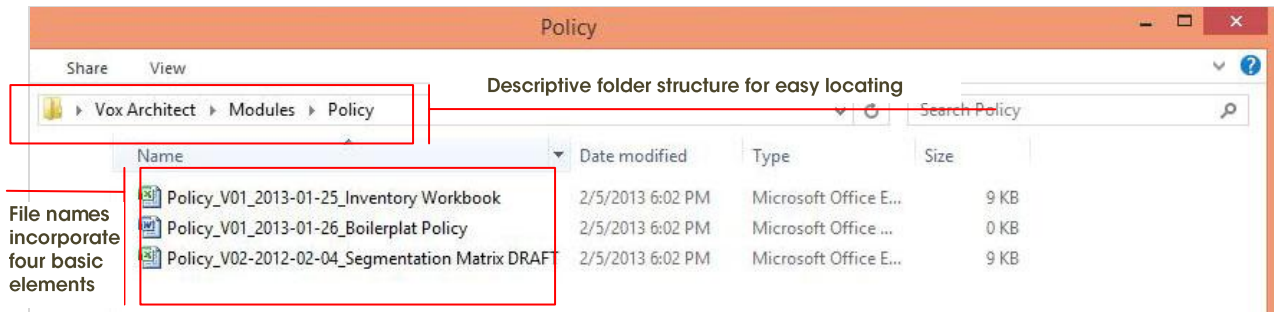
### 3.2. File structure

File names should contain enough information to adequately describe the content, but be short enough to help users quickly identify and locate the information they need. Regardless of the environment or folder structure, Vox Mobile’s file naming structure should include the elements indicated in Table 2.

**Table 2: The primary goal of naming files in a consistent, recognizable fashion is to help user quickly identify and locate the information they need.**

| Element                                  | Example            | Description/Explanation                                                                                                                     | How to Use                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Business Unit, Segment, or Module</b> | Policy             | Identifies the module, segment, or business unit to which the document belongs.                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Use the exact name of the business unit, segment, or module. Abbreviate where applicable.</li> </ul>                                       |
| <b>Version Number</b>                    | V01                | See section 3.3 Version control                                                                                                             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Use a two-digit version to facilitate sorting and displaying files in a logical order.</li> </ul>                                          |
| <b>Date</b>                              | 2013-01-28         | Initially, this will be the date the document was created. Afterwards, this will be the date the document was updated.                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Use the metric (international) date standard <b>YYYY-MM-DD</b> to facilitate sorting and displaying files in a logical order.</li> </ul>   |
| <b>Title</b>                             | Inventory Workbook | The title should be intuitive to the user, but not unreasonably long. When creating multiple versions, use the same title for all versions. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>■ Use a title that clearly describes the content of the document.</li> <li>■ Do not use hyphenation or underscoring in the title.</li> </ul> |

Separate each element with an underscore (“\_”). Reserve hyphens for sub-version numbers and dates. Using the folder structure and file structure elements from the table above, a completely organized file and folder structure for the Policy Module would look like what is shown in Figure 1.



**Figure 1: A clearly delineated folder structure combined with an effective file naming strategy ensures your workspace is cleaner, more organized, and easily accessible.**

### 3.3. Version control

Fast-changing projects with multiple authors need a version control system to track changes and avoid general file and folder chaos. At a minimum, authors should have a consistent way of identifying which version of a file they are working on.

There is no industry approach to identifying a new version. In many cases, when significant changes have been made to a document, a new version would be created. However, this is dependent on the information content and business context.

In the case where multiple team members are making changes to the same version of the document, team members should determine when to create a new version. Here are a few things to consider:

#### 3.3.1. Rule-of-thumb for revisions

Add or update version number only when making a change **and** releasing the document for review by others or the team. If you make multiple rounds of edits (over the course of a few days), but have not released the document, all those changes would be made under the same version number.

#### 3.3.2. The final document

When the document is finalized and has been published, make a copy of the most recently edited and cleaned up document and change the version number to the word "FINAL" (e.g., Policy\_FINAL\_2013-03-01\_Inventory Workbook).

## 4. PARTING THOUGHTS

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Consider these guidelines as a valuable tool for helping you develop business documentation that is consistent with Vox Mobile's values, professionalism, and personality.

- Company standards and style guides are part of the overall company guidelines required for producing consistent information.
- It is the responsibility of all content developers to ensure that the documents they produce adhere to these guidelines.
- It is important that team leaders ensure adherence to these style guidelines from their respective content development teams.
- This style guide should be updated regularly and made available to the entire team in a central and easily accessible location.

### 4.1. Additional resources

- **www.whatis.com** – The leading IT encyclopedia and learning center
- **www.websters-online-dictionary.org** – Webster's Online Dictionary with Multilingual Thesaurus Translation
- **www.m-w.com** – Merriam-Webster Online Search
- **www.techweb.com/encyclopedia/** – TechWeb: The Business Technology Network
- **www.webopedia.com** – The only online dictionary and search engine you need for computer and Internet technology definitions.

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